

Ali Wallick

Game Developer

contact@aliwallick.com aliwallick.com linkedin.com/in/aliwallick

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer I · Second Dinner

2019 – Present

Irvine, CA · Previously Software Engineer II (2019 – Dec 2021)

- Joined as the studio's 11th employee, before it had shipped anything. Five years on Marvel Snap, which launched in October 2022, then its next team from 2024 — the studio's first game in Godot.
- Championed and helped lead a migration to MVVM architecture on a live product, alongside the push to ship the PC client.
- Shipped Snap on PC in two stages: a direct mobile port for Steam Early Access at the October 2022 launch, then reworked much of the UI to be landscape- and mouse-and-keyboard-native for the Early Access exit in August 2023.
- Owned localization end to end — Unity's Localization package, the import/export pipeline, font handling, and the workflow the team localized UI text through.
- Built the Braze integration that let live-ops and marketing ship content without an app update: main-screen carousel, news page, and modal pop-ups.
- Early client engineering in Unity: push notifications, deep linking, the first pass of localization, and integrating live-ops tooling into the client.
- Later feature engineering: meta gameplay systems spanning client and server code plus the UI for them, card and deck cosmetics, and the deckbuilding UI.

Software Engineer II · MobilityWare

2016 – 2019

Irvine, CA

- Architected Vegas Blvd Slots' live-ops systems — a server-controllable store and a DeltaDNA integration driving in-app messaging, promo carousels, and eventing, with customizable text so marketing could run campaigns without engineering.
- Engineered new slot machines and their features and bonus games, on a title carrying 50+ machines plus rewards, gifting, leagues, and tournaments.
- Pitched It Fits I Sits at the studio game jam and built the week-long prototype, focused on a level editor that exported JSON and let us author 61 levels for pitch day. Won People's Choice; other teams took it to release, later as Puzzle Cats.
- Led cross-cutting work that spanned the whole title, including GDPR support and keeping the game current through several major Unity version upgrades.
- Ported the previous slots title, Hot Streak Slots, from native iOS to Unity, and built blackjack, video poker, and keno for an early unreleased casino app.

UI Programmer · Red 5 Studios

Jun 2015 – 2016

Irvine, CA

- Built UI across Firefall's HUD and menus — radar, PvP HUD, character progression and elite-level screens, reward screens — through its Chinese launch and worldwide relaunch overhaul.
- Created shared libraries for common menu and HUD elements, and optimized the UI system itself on an already-loaded client.
- Worked at the boundary between the Lua/XML UI scripting layer and the studio's C++ engine, on a team and codebase substantially larger than anything I'd worked on before.

Software Engineer · Kaneva, LLC

2011 – 2015

Atlanta, GA

- Architected a menu animation system adopted by both the UI and game teams, after hand-coding every transition became the bottleneck.
- Built many of Kaneva's core menus end to end in the in-house Lua menu system — player and creator HUDs, inventory and bank, travel, events, and a visual property editor for scripted objects — from artists' comps through layout to functionality.
- Part of the team that designed and scripted a Lua-based game development environment on top of the virtual world.
- Started in technical support, helping players with their in-world scripting and building game templates — Treasure Hunt and Adventure among them — that let players assemble small games of their own.
- Also built context menus for people and objects, menus for swapping video and Flash content on in-game objects, and the welcome and builder tutorials, working with the engine and web teams whenever a menu touched either.

EDUCATION

B.S. Computational Media · Georgia Institute of Technology

2011

Atlanta, GA

TOOLS

Unity · C# · Godot · GDScript · DeltaDNA · Lua · XML · C++